



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: New Braunfels Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.nbcata.org/page/the-classical-school/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

New Braunfels Christian Academy (NBCA), as represented by the publicly accessible crawl content, does not provide substantive textual evidence of a classical education orientation across the six canonical categories. The only surfaced material is a 404-page that references "the classical school" in its URL structure but contains no explicit discussion of classical curriculum, pedagogy, theology, or community practices. This absence of explicit classical content yields a NOT CLASSICAL rating across all six categories when measured against the classical rubric and keyword framework.

Key context from the sources: - NBCA crawl content surfaces a page titled "The Classical School" but the live content is blocked (404/recaptcha). This limits verifiable evidence of any classical programmatic features on NBCA's site. This is shown in the crawl excerpt that includes a page-not-found message and recaptcha notice. - The classical education rubric relies on a structured set of six elements (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations; Purpose and Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community) and a defined Positive/Negative Keyword framework. The Positive Keyword Indicators include explicit terms around truth, goodness, beauty, theology, liturgy, Great Books, Socratic pedagogy, scholé, wonder, etc., while Negative Keywords flag tendencies away from classical aims. - The keyword lexicon for classical education further delineates the expected positive indicators (e.g., transcendental realism, sacred tradition, liturgy, great conversation, the Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, scholé, wonder) and negative signals (e.g., values-neutral education, project-based learning emphasis, experiential-only approaches). This vocabulary provides a concrete basis for scoring NBCA against a classical standard.

Overall classification: NOT CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The NBCA public crawl yields a page indicating a 404 for a page titled "The Classical School," with no accessible text discussing transcendental moral realism, theology, liturgical practice, or communal worship. This provides no explicit evidence of transcendental moral realism, theological grounding, or liturgical practices on NBCA's public site.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords (from the Six Essential Elements lexicon) include terms like truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; wonder; great conversation; etc. NBCA's accessible text does not surface those terms in a way that supports a Classical alignment (0 positive keywords surfaced; zero discernible matches to the listed positive indicators). See the keyword framework in the classical elements document and lexicon.
 - Negative keywords: no explicit signals of secularism or value-neutral approaches appear in the NBCA crawl (0 matches). The absence of both positive and negative indicators yields a data gap rather than an affirmative classical alignment.

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- Why this rating
 - Without explicit evidence of transcendental moral realism, theology, or liturgical/community practices, NBCA's public materials do not meet the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations criteria as defined by the classical rubric. The absence of these signals supports a NOT CLASSICAL rating for this category. The 404-page context reinforces the lack of accessible, affirmative material.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - No explicit articulation of formation toward virtue and wisdom, rather than work preparation, is visible in NBCA's public crawl. The accessible material does not state a purpose centered on formation, the true/good/beautiful, or human excellence as telos. The evidence is effectively absent.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators (e.g., formation, virtue cultivation, human flourishing, telos) are not present in the NBCA text that is publicly surfaced. 0 positive keyword hits; 0 negative keyword hits. The rubric and lexicon would require explicit articulation of these aims to contribute to a Classical designation.
- Why this rating
 - With no public statements about virtue-centered formation, human excellence as a goal, or the pursuit of true/good/beautiful knowledge, NBCA does not meet the Element 2 criteria for a Classical school. The lack of content precludes a positive classification in this area.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - There is no accessible NBCA public material describing a liberal arts curriculum, grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, or history taught as a Great Conversation. The publicly crawlable content is limited to a 404 page for a page titled "The Classical School." No curriculum specifics are visible.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators such as the Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books literature, Latin/Greek, or the Great Conversation are not evidenced in the NBCA crawl. 0 positive keyword hits; 0 negative keyword hits.
- Why this rating
 - The curriculum elements central to Christian classical education are not evidenced in the public content surfaced for NBCA. In the absence of explicit Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium alignment, or a canon of liberal arts, Element 3 is NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - No publicly available NBCA materials demonstrate Socratic dialogue, seminars, recitation, memory work, scholé-based rest, or rhetoric training at any grade level. The crawl content does not reveal teaching method details.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive pedagogical indicators (e.g., Socratic seminars, chanting, memory work, restfulness/scholé) are not surfaced in NBCA's public crawl; 0 positive keyword hits; 0 negative keyword hits.
- Why this rating
 - The pedagogy criteria of classical education require explicit evidence of contemplative, resting forms of study and/or Socratic or rhetoric-focused high school strategy. The NBCA crawl lacks such content, leading to a NOT CLASSICAL rating for pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - There is no publicly accessible NBCA material describing a living curriculum via faculty, a portrait of teacher ideals, or a “faculty of friends” community. The public crawl yields no faculty descriptions.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators (e.g., model teachers, living curriculum, faculty as mentors) are not evidenced in NBCA’s public content. 0 positive keyword hits; 0 negative keyword hits.
- Why this rating
 - Absent publicly visible statements or profiles of a classical faculty model, NBCA cannot meet the Faculty category criteria. Thus, NOT CLASSICAL for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The NBCA crawl contains no accessible public content describing partnerships with parents as co-teachers, parent formation, open campus policies, or parent involvement programs. The page data available is a 404, with no community-facing statements.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators such as parent partnerships, parent formation events, and welcoming open visits are not evidenced in the NBCA materials surfaced. 0 positive keyword hits; 0 negative keyword hits.
- Why this rating
 - Without accessible public statements about parent partnerships or community engagement in a classical formation framework, Element 6 is NOT CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment: NOT CLASSICAL

- The six-category scan yields NOT CLASSICAL across the board, driven by an absence of publicly accessible classical content on NBCA’s crawl and the need to meet a robust set of classical-education indicators (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, scholé, liturgy, etc.) as defined in the Six Essential Elements framework and its keyword indicators. See the Six Essential Elements rubric for category criteria and keywords, and the keyword lexicon for the positive/negative term sets used to evaluate each category.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here, as the aggregate classification is NOT CLASSICAL. No category is presently closer to CLASSICAL or SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL; therefore, there is no group of concrete items to target for a needle-moving improvement within the scope of this NBCA evaluation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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